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Fun Fact

The First Press Release Came Out of a Train Crash

Raise It With Press Release

swipe →



28 October 1906

A train run by a Pennsylvania Railroad subsidiary plunged off a bridge in Atlantic City, USA. Railways then usually **kept reporters away** and said little about the cause.

Source: Billy Penn (2023); Museum of Public Relations

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Ivy Lee Chose to Speak First

Publicist Ivy Lee wrote the company's own statement, handed it to reporters and gave them access to the site.

Source: Billy Penn (2023); Museum of Public Relations

Fun Fact

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30.10.1906

The New York Times printed it word for word

That statement is often called the first press release of modern public relations.

Source: Billy Penn (2023); Museum of Public Relations

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Lessons That Still Work 120 Years Later

- Speak first, before someone else frames your story
- Facts beat claims
- Make the journalist's job easier: access, data, sources

06/06 *Fun Fact*

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The Press Release Was Born in a Crisis. Now It's Built for Growth.

1. Save it for your next team training
2. Tag a colleague who loves PR history

Source:
· Billy Penn, 2023
· Museum of Public Relations